

WILL MCGOWAN

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EDUCATION

University of Strathclyde, Glasgow

Sep 2023 - Jun 2027 (expected)

BA (Hons) Economics

- Average grade to date: 2:1
- **Relevant Modules:** Treasury Management and Derivatives; Industrial Economics; Applied Econometrics

Dissertation | MATLAB

In progress, due 2027

"Does the News Pay? Forecasting European Gas Volatility with MIDAS, Storage and Text Data"

- Testing whether news attention improves forecasts of TTF gas price volatility using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models, and whether better forecasts add value in a volatility-targeted futures strategy
- Constructing an original gas-market attention index from Google Trends, alongside published geopolitical and policy uncertainty indices

FX Risk Management | group project

Treasury Management and Derivatives

- Assessed how six global companies, including Toyota, Nestlé, NVIDIA and Reliance Industries, are exposed to and manage currency risk on both the revenue and cost side

Empirical CAPM Test

MATLAB, Python

- Tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries (JKP global factor data): zero alpha rejected for 32% at 5% and jointly (GRS) in 48 of 52 countries, with momentum and value the most persistent

Monte Carlo Option Pricing Engine

MATLAB, Python

- Priced European and Asian options by simulation; a geometric-Asian control variate reduced the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% vs plain Monte Carlo

Belfast Royal Academy, Belfast

Jun 2023

- A-levels: Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Computer Science (B)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Le Set, Glasgow | Head Mixologist

Sep 2026 - Present

- Created 4 original house cocktails and wrote the specifications for the 7 classics on the menu of a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge, opened Sep 2026
- Wrote batch specifications for 5 prebatched cocktails and trained around 15 bar staff to prepare and serve them consistently

KONG, Glasgow | Mixologist and Front of House

Oct 2024 - Jun 2026

- Analysed sales patterns to refine upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%
- Reconciled cash and card takings at the end of each shift and trained new staff on drink specifications, POS workflows and licensing compliance

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

Strathclyde Agricapital Society | Co-Founder and Treasurer

Sep 2025 - Present

- Co-founded the university's first agri-finance society and grew membership to 126
- Led weekly research sessions on agribusiness transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down deal rationale, structure and valuation for members
- Manage the society's budget and accounts as Treasurer

Strathclyde Poker Society | Vice-President, then President

Sep 2025 - Apr 2026

- Ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: Excel, R, MATLAB, Python, Git

Interests: chess, 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships (2023) and won 21 of 22 games in a simultaneous exhibition against players averaging 1860 FIDE; powerlifting, Northern Ireland U19 champion (2023)